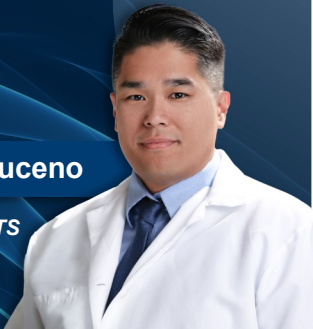


January 15, 2025



Wildfires and Their Impact on Health

The Eaton and Palisades Fires [rank among the most destructive in California's history](#). A significant health risk associated with wildfires is smoke, which can affect people even if they live a distance away from the actual fire.

Wildfire Smoke

Wildfire smoke [contains harmful particles from the materials burned](#), including lung irritants, carcinogens, and neurotoxins. These substances can lead to a variety of health issues. Those most vulnerable to these effects include individuals with chronic respiratory or cardiovascular conditions, young children, older adults, outdoor workers, and people with physical disabilities.

Managing Risks

Check air quality: Fire-related air quality conditions can be found at [AirNow's Fire and Smoke Map](#).

Masking while outdoors: A high-quality mask, such as an N95, can be helpful. Children younger than 2 years of age should not wear a mask.

Indoor air filtration: Ensure home air filters are functioning properly and replace them when needed. Filters with a higher MERV rating (ideally, MERV 13 or higher) are more effective at trapping air pollutants. Portable air filters with HEPA filters in individual rooms can help reduce exposure to smoke indoors.

Additional information and resources to share with our members can be found here on [KP.ORG](#).



References

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